

WATSON NKOMO

SOC Analyst (Tier 1 & 2) | Incident Responder | Cybersecurity Analyst

+27 83 724 8693 | wattienk@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/watson-nkomo | Johannesburg, ZA

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 2+ years of hands-on SOC experience spanning Tier 1 triage and Tier 2 incident response, threat hunting, and SOC operations management. Triaged 1,000+ security alerts across SIEM platforms including Splunk and Wazuh, executing incident response aligned to NIST SP 800-61 and mapping adversary behaviour to MITRE ATT&CK. Currently serving as a Tier 2 escalation analyst and team lead at ScaryByte - owning SOP& playbook development, L1 analyst training, client reporting, and SLA-driven alert queue governance. Certified in CompTIA Security+, ISO 27001 ISMS, and Cisco Ethical Hacking, with active pursuit of SOC and cloud security advancement.

CORE COMPETENCIES

• SOC Tier 1 & 2 Operations	• SIEM (Splunk, Wazuh, Graylog)	• MITRE ATT&CK Mapping
• Incident Response (NIST 800-61)	• Threat Hunting Intel Analysis & Triaging	• Vulnerability Assessment & Management
• Playbook Development & SOC Ops	• Risk Assessment & Compliance	• Endpoint Detection & Response (EDR)
• Network & Application Security	• IAM & Zero-Trust Principles	• Security Awareness & L1 Coaching

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst — Tier 2 & SOC Manager | ScaryByte

2026 – Present

- Serve as primary escalation point for Tier 1 analysts, owning deep-dive investigation of complex incidents across SIEM telemetry, endpoint data, and threat intelligence feeds — reducing average escalation to resolution time by an estimated 30%.
- Govern SLA-driven alert queue prioritisation for a multi-analyst SOC team, ensuring critical severity incidents are triaged and contained within defined response windows.
- Orchestrated end-to-end incident response for high-severity events including ransomware precursor activity, credential dumping, brute-force, Rogue device/ Shadow IT and lateral movement - mapping attacker TTPs to MITRE ATT&CK and coordinating containment actions across endpoints and network perimeter.
- Engineered and maintained SOC playbooks covering phishing response, brute-force detection, privilege escalation, and data exfiltration, standardising L1 analyst response procedures and cutting investigation duplication.
- Lead structured threat-hunting campaigns using Wazuh endpoint telemetry and Graylog log analysis, proactively identifying indicators of compromise and MITRE ATT&CK technique patterns before alert escalation.
- Own analyst scheduling, shift handover documentation, and client-facing incident reports, ensuring operational continuity and transparent stakeholder communication.
- Deliver ongoing L1 analyst training and mentoring, covering alert triage methodology, SIEM query techniques, and NIST SP 800-61 IR lifecycle, improving team proficiency and reducing repeat escalations.

SOC Analyst — Tier 1 & IT Support Technician | ScaryByte

2024 – 2025

- Triaged 1,000+ security alerts using SIEM platforms, classifying and escalating phishing, brute-force, data exfiltration, and privilege escalation incidents
- Investigated and contained endpoint threats using EDR and Windows Event Log forensics, reducing dwell time through rapid identification of malicious processes and affected user accounts.
- Performed threat hunting across network and endpoint telemetry, leveraging MITRE ATT&CK framework to map suspicious behaviour patterns and identify TTPs consistent with known threat actor campaigns.
- Administered Active Directory user and group management, VPN provisioning, and MFA enforcement for a distributed workforce - achieving 100% secure remote access uptime across managed endpoints.
- Managed IT support operations via Freshdesk ticketing system, resolving hardware, software, and network incidents while documenting resolution steps to build internal knowledge base.

Project Manager | Watty Holdings Pty Ltd | Teacher & Facilitator

2015 – 2023

- Directed simultaneous delivery of multiple technology and operational projects, applying risk management frameworks to mitigate schedule and resource risks - consistently meeting project milestones.
- Coordinated cross-functional teams across technical and business units, translating stakeholder requirements into actionable project plans aligned to organisational security and governance policies.
- Teaching High school & Facilitating NQF Level 1-2

INDUSTRY PROGRAMMES & SIMULATIONS

- Mastercard Cybersecurity Virtual Internship (Jul 2024): Operated as a Security Awareness analyst — identified phishing threats, assessed business unit vulnerability to social engineering, and designed targeted security training programmes to address capability gaps.
- PwC Switzerland Cybersecurity Job Simulation — Forage (Jul 2024): Conducted enterprise-level risk assessments, formulated integrated defence strategy recommendations, and implemented network segmentation and firewall configuration solutions for a simulated client engagement.
- Telstra Cybersecurity Job Simulation: Responded to a live-scenario malware attack — performed attack analysis, executed technical mitigation actions, and produced a post-incident review report including root cause analysis and remediation recommendations.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **CompTIA Security+** - CompTIA | Apr 2024
- **ISO 27001 ISMS Lead Implementer** - Securium Academy | Jan 2025
- **Ethical Hacker** - Cisco Academy | Jun 2024
- **AI Ethics & Governance** - D2L | Sep 2024
- **Wazuh for Security Engineers** - Wazuh | 2025
- **SOC Fundamentals** - Lets Defend | Oct 2024
- **AWS Cloud Essentials Practitioner** - AWS | Nov 2024
- **Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate** - Coursera / Google | Oct 2023
- **Currently pursuing: CompTIA CYSA+** — target completion Q3 2026

EDUCATION

Diploma in Governance & Leadership

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

SIEM / SOAR	Splunk (custom SPL queries) Wazuh (dashboards, security engineering & alerting) Graylog
EDR / XDR	Wazuh EDR Windows Defender SOAR-assisted response workflows
Network Security	Wireshark Nmap IDS/IPS configuration Firewall rule management Network segmentation
Threat Intel	Virus Total AbuseIPDB Any. Run malware sandbox MITRE ATT&CK Navigator
Forensics & IR	Windows Event Viewer NIST SP 800-61 IR lifecycle Malware analysis Incident post-mortem
Cloud Security	AWS Cloud Essentials Cloud security posture awareness IAM Zero-trust principles
IAM & Compliance	Active Directory MFA PCI DSS GDPR ISO 27001 NIST CSF OWASP Top 10 CIS Benchmark AI Governance
Scripting & Automation	Python (automation scripting) SQL
OS & Platforms	Windows Server Linux (Ubuntu/Kali) VPN administration